



MONTHLY UPDATE

Seychelles: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 • 13 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • DPI • INCLUSION • DATA

Summary of the month

The month's clearest movement is backwards, and it is about the press. An Afrobarometer dispatch published on 11 August [found perceived media freedom down since the previous round](#), two months after Parliament amended the [broadcasting statute to move appointment and dismissal power over the public broadcaster's board](#); the same dispatch is the base's first reading of public support for access to government information.

The rest is institutional. The national science, technology and innovation institute [was reinstated with its secretariat under the Office of the Vice-President](#), and the President [restated the fully-digitalised-government-by-2030 target](#) with no plan or milestone attached to it. Two systems advanced: [a social-protection delivery platform, with stakeholders briefed on 18 August](#), and [a small-island resilience data programme, whose national implementation launched the same day](#). Bilateral consultations with India on adopting its health and office platforms [are reported as advancing](#), with nothing signed.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Cabinet approved measures to operationalise the Multidimensional Vulnerability Index on 22 July 2026, naming "enhanced data and institutional capacity" and alignment of planning and budgeting frameworks as the instruments, with no implementation detail yet given. [President Herminie restated a "fully digitalised e-government by 2030" target on 4 August](#), while receiving Malta's first High Commissioner's credentials and naming bilateral technical cooperation as the route under discussion. On 10 August the institution meant to carry that work was described as back in place: [the National Institute for Science, Technology and Innovation has been reinstated, its Secretariat sitting under the Office of the Vice-President](#) after five years in which it was closed and its functions folded into a ministry division. Its Secretary of State puts its near-term focus on technological innovation in government procedures and on accelerating the digitalisation of public-service delivery. No commencement notice for the NISTI Act 2025 is on record, so the body is described as functioning without the statute behind it being shown to be in force.

Data protection

The information commission's visible work is inducting the officers other public bodies must appoint. It [held the second of its two annual induction sessions for newly appointed information officers, led by its chief executive and a senior information analyst](#). The enforcement half of its mandate still shows no case: it has been the designated data-

protection authority since December 2023, an enforcement-capacity gap was documented in November 2025, and no audit, investigation or fine against any controller has been reported. No count of officers inducted or bodies covered is published.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

[Parliament amended the Seychelles Broadcasting Corporation Act in June 2026](#), transferring greater power over the appointment and dismissal of the public broadcaster's board from the independent Constitutional Appointments Authority to the President. The base holds no primary text of the amendment; what it holds is Afrobarometer's August dispatch, which reports it citing Broadcast Media Africa and the International Press Institute, and sets it against the survey it was publishing.

That survey, fielded in 2025, finds [45% of Seychellois calling the media somewhat or completely free, down from 51% in 2022, with 52% saying it is not very or not at all free](#) — a decline recorded on a media environment that Reporters Without Borders ranked 35th globally in 2026, up ten places. Appetite for oversight is not in doubt: [78% want the media to investigate government mistakes and corruption constantly, and 85% back the right to publish without government interference](#).

DPI

Data Exchange

The corridor Seychelles had a memorandum for was signed with somebody else. The AfCFTA Secretariat and Quest Ghana [signed a joint venture agreement in Accra on 31 August to establish the AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor, to facilitate, track and settle cross-border trade transactions](#) — the same secretariat and the same company as the Seychelles memorandum of March, which remains under review. The corridor is proceeding, and it is proceeding through Accra. Nothing in the record held says whether the Seychelles arrangement is superseded, subsumed or simply waiting.

Sectoral management information systems

[Firstpost reported on 8 August 2026](#) that bilateral consultations between India and Seychelles on adopting the e-Sanjeevani, e-Office and e-Hospital platforms were advancing, with no MoU, pilot or date yet established.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The social-protection agency [briefed stakeholders on 18 August on a platform to modernise benefit delivery](#). It is at the briefing stage: no go-live date, caseload or connection to the identity or payment layers is stated.

Inclusion

Access to services

The same survey puts a number on demand for open government, which the Access to Information Act reform has been drafted against since November 2025 without a Bill reaching Parliament. [62% say the public should have access to government information, against 25% who say it is for officials only](#); support is strongest where the information is fiscal — [84% for district-administration budgets and 82% for bids and contracts on government projects](#) — and falls to 47% for the salaries of district administrators and teachers.

Data

National statistics

The statistical work of the window is climate data with a funding line behind it. Seychelles [launched its national implementation of a nine-country African island-states resilience programme](#), backed by a US\$4.943 million readiness grant, whose data leg is a [standardised approach to institutional readiness, multi-hazard risk assessment and information systems](#), the stated purpose being to build pipelines of climate-resilient projects able to reach international finance. The grant figure covers all nine countries; the national share is not published, so the base can date the launch and not size it.

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